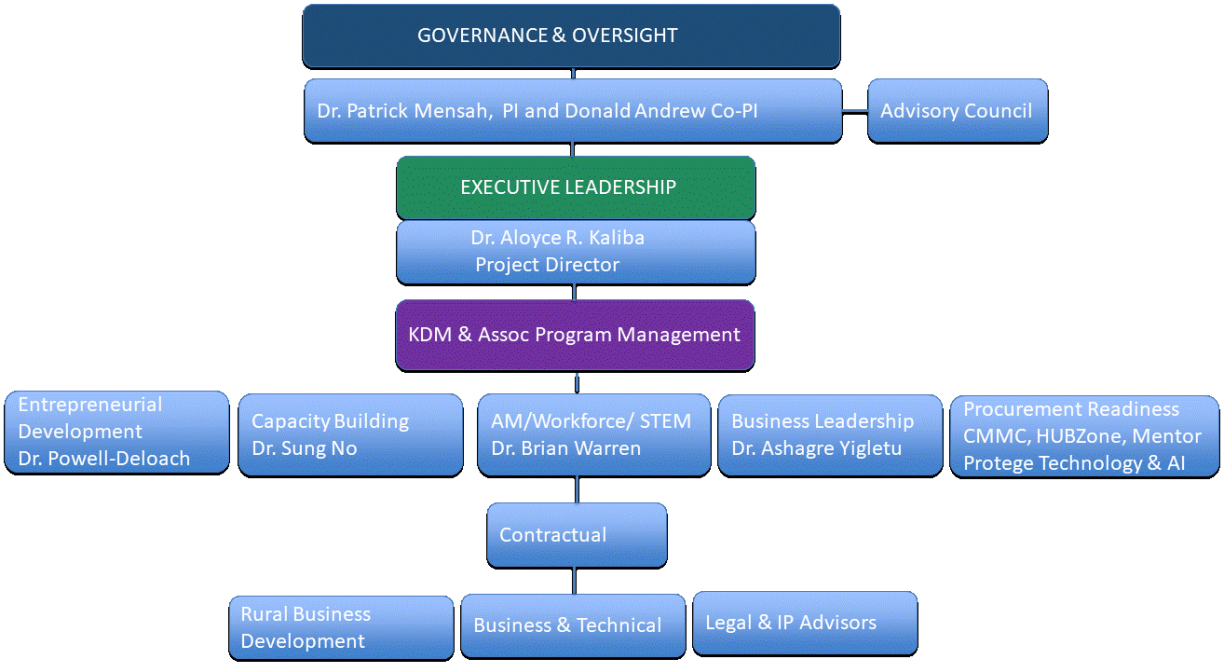


Figure 1Key Personnel Organizational Chart

3. Project Performance & Start-up (25 points)

3.a Project Impact Narrative & Theory of Change (5 points)

Theory of change: if rural Louisiana firms receive coordinated, assessment-driven technical assistance — capital readiness, procurement readiness, advanced-manufacturing capability, and digital/AI enablement — delivered through one accountable point of entry and tracked with real-time data, then they will start, formalize, and grow; access more capital and contracts; create and retain jobs; and raise revenue, producing a more resilient rural ecosystem. Each activity in Section 1.b maps to a specific MBDA core measure (below). Data collection is built into delivery: the KDM platform captures baseline and progress data at intake and at every touchpoint, supports confidential, role-based access, and is queryable with AI for real-time tracking. The Center will collect more data than MBDA requires for reporting so it can manage adaptively — flagging off-track clients and redirecting services — and will transmit required data to MBDA through the designated performance system.

3.b Core Performance Measures & Targets (5 points)

The Center tracks all five MBDA core measures plus project-specific measures, with annual numeric targets that reflect a deliberate ramp-up. MBDA assesses performance semi-annually; the Center will report at the 6-month mark against a straight-line interpolation of annual targets and will reflect rural seasonality (e.g., agricultural and coastal cycles) in its projections.

Measure (core measures in bold)	Yr 1	Yr 2	Yr 3	3-Yr Total	Data source
Clients Served	100	150	250	500	Intake / CRM

Measure (core measures in bold)	Yr 1	Yr 2	Yr 3	3-Yr Total	Data source
New Business Starts	10	15	25	50	Registrations
Capital Infusion	$375K	$750K	$1.0M	$2.125M	Financial docs
Jobs Supported	100	200	300	600	Payroll/self-report
% Businesses w/ Revenue Growth	20%	30%	40%	—	Pre/post financials
Training activities delivered	20	25	30	75	Program logs
Capital-readiness packages	15	25	30	70	Completed docs
Contracts secured (incl. HUBZone/Prime/OEM)	5	10	15	30	Contract docs
Digital adoption (e-commerce / AI users)	25	40	50	115	Surveys/usage
AM business-program participants; CMMC/HUBZone/OZ readiness completions	10	15	20	45	Cohort/cert logs

3.c Feasibility of Targets (5 points)

Targets are ambitious yet realistic given the $1,274,999 request and Southern's existing capacity. The cohort-based, continuous model ensures a steady participant pipeline; the SBDC's prior reach (3,000+ entrepreneurs; $50M+ capital facilitated) and the documented depth of unmet rural need supply more than enough demand to meet client targets. Year 1 targets are deliberately moderate to reflect start-up ramp; Years 2–3 scale as cohorts mature and the platform compounds reach. Cost-per-outcome benchmarks (cost per client served, per new start, per job) are reasonable for a single-institution delivery model that concentrates the award and avoids coordination overhead, investing deeply in rural-parish delivery through existing extension infrastructure. The integration of data-driven monitoring and adaptive program delivery ensures that targets remain achievable. The Center will continuously assess performance and adjust activities to improve outcomes, ensuring alignment with MBDA expectations for measurable and accountable results.

3.d Start-up Plan — First 90 Days (10 points)

The Center will reach operational readiness within 90 days through six parallel workstreams:

(1) Staffing — confirm and onboard the Project Director, program managers, AM lab manager, and the KDM PMO; establish roles, reporting lines, and data-reporting training.